



Groundwater

In the water cycle, some water seeps underground, where it collects in rocks and sometimes forms pools in caves. Some groundwater is pumped up and used for drinking or irrigation.



Damp ground

Wetlands form on land in areas where freshwater does not drain away. They provide a habitat for many plants, birds, animals, and fish.

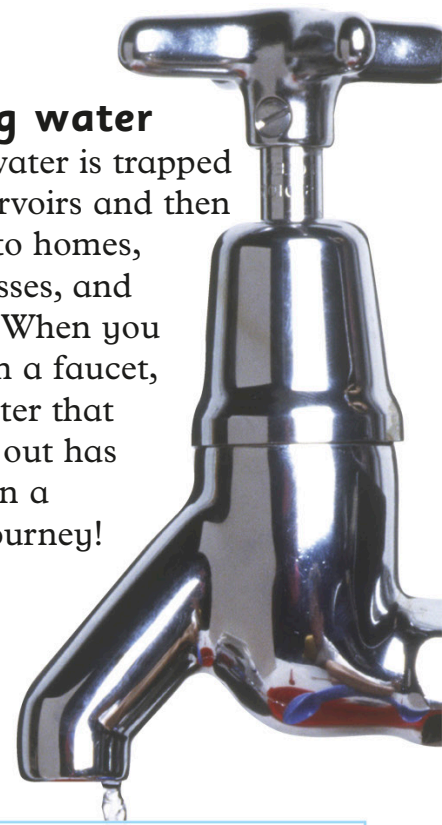
Drought

When very little rain falls, experts call it a drought. Droughts do not occur only in deserts—any area that gets much less rain than usual is said to be suffering from drought.



Using water

Freshwater is trapped in reservoirs and then piped to homes, businesses, and farms. When you turn on a faucet, the water that comes out has been on a long journey!



Saving water

There is a limited amount of freshwater on the Earth. If we want to make sure there's enough to go around, it's important that everyone uses less.



Turn off faucets while you are brushing your teeth or washing.



Flush the toilet only when necessary. Some toilets have two flush controls.



Don't run the dishwasher when it's half empty—wait until it's full.



Take a shower instead of a bath. Showering uses much less water.